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Sri Lanka Institute of Information Technology

B. Sc. Honours Degree in Information Technology
Specializing in Information Technology

Final Examination
Year 4, Semester II (2023)

IT4050 - Innovation Management and Entrepreneurship

Duration: 2 Hours

November 2023

Instructions to Candidates:

- This paper has Four (4) questions. Answer all questions.
- Write down the answers ONLY in the answer booklet provided.
- Total Marks 100 (This paper counts for 70% of Module Marks).
- Read all questions before start answering.
- This paper contains 3 pages with the Cover Page.

Question 1: Innovation management (25 marks)

I. Argue on "Innovation is a must to sustain a business in the long run".

(3 marks)

II. Why innovations fail to achieve market success? Give reasons considering the *innovation sweet spot*.

(4 marks)

III. Sri Lanka is currently going through a challenging period due to its economic crisis. Does this situation have a positive impact or a negative impact? Justify your answer.

(4 marks)

IV. Assume you have been appointed as a consultant to a project that develops a mobile application for visually impaired citizens. You have given 10 team members who are from the software engineering, quality assurance, and UX/UI departments.

a. Select three creative idea-generating techniques that can be used in designing this app. Justify your selection.

(6 marks)

b. If you are free to invite outsiders to help you with this project, who do you invite to join this project? Give reasons.

(2 marks)

V. How does the 'House of Quality, (HoQ)' a tool in Quality Function Deployment (QFD), help in planning and communication between different parts of a company? In HoQ, explain how customer concerns (Customer Attributes) are taken into account and shared with various teams during the development of a new product.

(6 marks)

Question 2: Entrepreneur and Entrepreneurship (25 Marks)

I. *"Entrepreneurship is the pursuit of opportunity beyond resources controlled."*

– Professor Howard Stevenson

Taking the above definition into consideration, answer the following questions:

a. Discuss different opportunities that entrepreneurs exploit/utilize to achieve success in their businesses.

(4 marks)

b. From the given opportunities, what opportunity will you consider for your business plan assignment? Give reasons.

(4 marks)

II. How crucial are networking and building relationships for entrepreneurs?

(3 marks)

III. What are the strategies that an entrepreneur can use to develop his/her networking and relationship-building skills for business growth and opportunities?

(4 marks)

IV. Entrepreneurs can be classified in numerous ways. Name three Sri Lankan entrepreneurs. Describe how you could categorize them using different classifications. Explain why you have chosen these categories.

(6 marks)

V. Compare and contrast Entrepreneurship and Intrapreneurship.

(4 marks)

Question 3: Value Proposition and Business Model Canvas (25 Marks)

I. What does it mean by "*Inventors Bias*"?

(2 marks)

II. How Value Proposition Canvas (VPC) can be developed to remove such biases.

(3 marks)

III. Why the preparation of a "Lean Canvas" (LC) is more meaningful than preparing a "Business Model Canvas" (BMC) for a startup? Give 3 reasons highlighting differences between LC and BMC.

(6 marks)

IV. Describe the importance of customer segments in the Business Model Canvas. How can entrepreneurs identify and define their target customers effectively?

(4 marks)

V. Consider a well-known Sri Lankan or an overseas company that is familiar to you. Use the Business Model Canvas to analyse its business model.

(10 marks)

Question 4: Business Plan (25 Marks)

I. What are the three (03) tests that every Business Plan must pass? Briefly explain those tests.

(3 marks)

II. Explain how you have justified that your business plan (submitted in the assignment) will pass those three (03) tests. What are the sections that you entered in the business plan to support your justification?

(6 marks)

III. Why cash is so important to a business?

(2 marks)

IV. What documents did you create for the business plan assignment to demonstrate that your future business can be successful through effective cash and finance management?

(3 marks)

V. Describe three different marketing channels a businessperson can use to reach different customer segments.

(3 marks)

VI. If you're pitching your business plan to an angel investor who is giving you money to start your business, explain the four key things you focus on in your presentation. Why are these areas important to an angel investor? Justify your response.

(8 marks)

End of the Examination Paper